Temporary Graduate visa (subclass 485)

Post-Higher Education Work stream

This visa is for international students who have recently graduated with a degree from an Australian institution. It allows you to live, work and study in Australia temporarily.

About this visa

- With this visa, you can *(#aboutVisa-index-0)*
- How long can you stay *(#aboutVisa-index-1)*
- Stay longer *(#aboutVisa-index-2)*
- Include family *(#aboutVisa-index-3)*
- Cost *(#aboutVisa-index-4)*
- Apply from *(#aboutVisa-index-5)*
- Processing times *(#aboutVisa-index-6)*
- Your obligations *(#aboutVisa-index-7)*
- Travel *(#aboutVisa-index-8)*
- Visa label *(#aboutVisa-index-9)*

With this visa, you can

- stay in Australia for between 2 and 3 years after you have finished your studies
- travel, work or study in Australia during your stay.

You must find your own employment while on this visa.

How long can you stay

This is a temporary visa. The length of your stay in Australia will depend on the level of your Australian study qualification.

Ask a question

- Bachelor degree (including honours) – 2 years
- Masters (coursework and extended) – 2 years
- Masters (research) – 3 years
- Doctoral degree – 3 years.

The default Graduate Diploma stay period is 2 years, but may be longer where previous study would have attracted a longer stay period.

The length of stay for Indian nationals, as agreed in the Australia India – Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement (AI-ECTA), is as follows:

- Bachelor degree (including honours) – 2 years
- Bachelor degree (with first class honours in STEM, including ICT) – 3 years
- Masters (coursework, extended and research) – 3 years
- Doctoral degrees (PhD) – 4 years.

Hong Kong and British National Overseas passport holders may stay up to 5 years.

The visa starts on the date we grant your visa.

You can travel in and out of Australia while your visa is valid.

Stay longer

We cannot extend this visa.

You may be eligible to apply for a Second Post-Higher Education Work stream visa *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/temporary-graduate-485/second-post-study-work)*. For further information, see Eligibility. *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/temporary-graduate-485/second-post-study-work#Eligibility)*

You may be eligible for other skilled work visas. Use our visa finder to find out options for work *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-finder/work)*.

Current and future Temporary Graduate visa holders from Hong Kong may have a pathway to permanent residency after 5 years.

Include family

You can include members of your family unit in your application when you apply, if they are in Australia. You can add your children to the application until we decide on your application. You cannot add any other member of the family unit to your application during that period.

If you want to add your family member to your visa after we have granted it, they can apply as a subsequent entrant. They can apply from in or outside Australia. Family members who apply for this visa must meet our health and character requirements.

For more details, see when you have this visa *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/temporary-graduate-485/graduate-work#When)*.

Cost

The visa costs AUD5,750.00 for the main applicant (concessions apply in limited circumstances).

There is also a charge for each family member who applies for the visa with you.

Subsequent entrants, including children born offshore, must pay the full Visa Application Charge.

You might also have to pay other costs for:

- health checks
- police certificates
- biometrics

To work out what your visa will cost use the Visa Pricing Estimator *(/visas/visa-pricing-estimator?visa=485-34)*. The estimator does not take into account the other costs.

The Temporary Graduate visa is exempt from the Subsequent Temporary Application Charge.

Cost concession

A lower visa cost applies to eligible Pacific Island and Timor-Leste citizens who lodge a valid Temporary Graduate visa application.

We will charge eligible applicants the lower visa application cost during the application process in ImmiAccount *(https://online.immi.gov.au/lusc/login)*. We will recognise eligible applicants by the valid passport from the specified countries used in the application when they apply.

Family members are also eligible for the lower visa cost. We base this on the passport of the primary applicant (or visa holder who satisfies the primary visa criteria).

Pacific Island and Timor-Leste citizens primary applicants must hold a valid passport issued by one of the following countries:

- Federated States of Micronesia
- Fiji
- Kiribati
- Nauru
- Palau
- Papua New Guinea
- Republic of the Marshall Islands
- Samoa
- Solomon Islands
- Timor-Leste
- Tonga
- Tuvalu
- Vanuatu

Apply from

You can be in Australia (but not in immigration clearance) when you apply for this visa.

Subsequent entrants can be in or outside Australia when they apply.

All applicants can be in or outside Australia at the time of decision.

Processing times

For an indication of processing times for your visa, use the visa processing time guide tool *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-processing-times/global-visa-processing-times)*. This will show the processing times for recently decided applications. It is a guide only and not specific to your application.

Your application can take longer to process if:

- you do not fill it in correctly
- we need more information from you
- it takes us time to verify your information.

We cannot process your application if you do not pay the correct Visa Application Charge. We will notify you if this is the case and if necessary return your application.

Your obligations

You and your family must meet all visa conditions and follow Australian laws.

Learn more about conditions for this visa *(/visas/already-have-a-visa/check-visa-details-and-conditions/see-your-visa-conditions?product=485-34)*.

Travel

You can travel outside Australia and return as many times as you want while your visa is valid.

The time you spend outside Australia does not extend your visa.

Visa label

We will digitally link your visa to your passport. You will not get a label in your passport.

Last updated:
12 October 2026